

Who Patents in Critical Technologies?

	BIOTECHNOLOGY ⁷			SEMICONDUCTORS ⁷			COMPUTER TECHNOLOGY ⁷		
	2014	2024	CHANGE	2014	2024	CHANGE	2014	2024	CHANGE
 China	5,390	16,000	+197%	2,950	17,200	+482%	7,780	176,000	+2,160%
 United States	6,800	7,960	+17%	9,640	7,040	-27%	40,500	44,600	+10.2%
 Japan	2,560	2,270	-11.5%	21,200	14,500	-31.9%	22,700	17,900	-21.1%
 South Korea	1,980	2,200	+11.1%	8,120	9,610	+18.3%	9,230	16,300	+76.9%
 Germany	1,040	889	-14.8%	1,710	1,250	-27.1%	2,470	3,280	+33%
 United Kingdom	436	703	+61.2%	205	210	+2.44%	911	2,180	+139%
 Australia	206	154	-25.2%	28	12	-57.1%	215	258	+20%

⁷ Patents granted by each country’s patent office. Values are grants in 2014 and 2024 with the relative change between them. Countries are ordered by total 2024.

Data from World Intellectual Property Organization, “Patents Granted by Technology,” WIPO IP Statistics Data Center, 2024.
Chart by Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart, Stanford University.